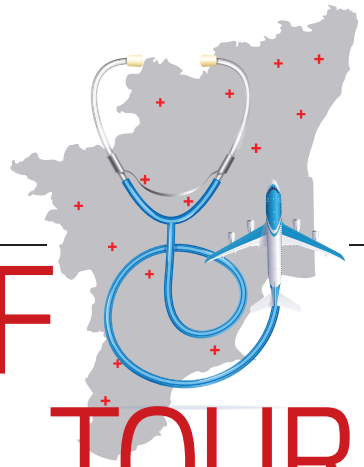




TAMIL NADU
A HUB OF MEDICAL TOURISM

With state-of-the-art hospitals across the state offering the latest treatments, Tamil Nadu is the go-to destination for medical tourists from around the world.







Tamil Nadu is India's leading medical tourism destination, and attracts patients from around the world. According to the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), every year about 15 lakh patients visit Tamil Nadu for medical diagnosis and treatment. The major hospitals have dedicated services for international patients, and patients from across India too, visit Tamil Nadu for treatment.

Tamil Nadu is known for its world-class medical facilities, highly trained medical professionals, and affordable treatment options. One of the key attractions of medical tourism in Tamil Nadu is its focus on traditional Indian healing practices, such as Ayurveda and Siddha. These practices offer a holistic approach to healing and are becoming increasingly popular among patients seeking alternative forms of treatment. In addition, Tamil Nadu also boasts advanced medical facilities, including state-of-the-art hospitals and specialised clinics. These facilities are equipped with the latest medical technology and staffed by experienced medical professionals, providing patients with the highest level of care. The Department of Tourism has also set up a Medical Tourism Information Centre in the Tamil Nadu Tourism Complex and Travel Desks in Chennai and Madurai.

The state has over 12,500 hospital beds, around 10 lakh registered doctors, 48 government-run medical colleges with hospitals; and hundreds of private specialty and multi-specialty hospitals. Besides, there are 1,491 Indian system hospitals and hundreds of Ayurvedic, Siddha, Unani and Homeopathy resources.

Incidentally, the first hospital in India was set up in Chennai in 1664. The Madras Christian College was set up in 1835 and the Christian Medical College, Vellore in 1900. The Cancer Institute in Adyar followed in 1954 and Sankara Nethralaya in 1976. Corporate hospitals came to Chennai with the setting up of Apollo in 1983. Thus, Tamil Nadu—and Chennai in particular—has an incomparable lineage when it comes to medical care.

Important hospitals in Chennai include government-aided ones like General Hospital, Government Multi-Super Speciality Hospital, Government Kilpauk Hospital, Government Royapettah Hospital, Government Stanley Hospital, Adyar Cancer Institute, and National Institute of Siddha. The National Institute of Siddha is one of seven apex national-level educational institutions promoting excellence in the Indian system of medicine and Ayurveda. Some popular private-run hospitals in Chennai are Apollo Hospitals, SIMS Hospital, Dr Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals, Global Health City, and OneHealth Super Speciality Hospital.

The prime NABH-accredited hospitals include Chennai Apollo Speciality Hospital, Dr Mehta Hospitals, Frontier Lifeline Hospital, Global Hospitals & Health City, and Sankara Nethralaya. Poonamallee High Road, with more hospitals than any other road in the city, is known as Chennai's 'Med Street'. The first hospital in India to receive halal certification from the Halal Development Authority is Chennai's Global Health City, pertinent since a majority of the medical tourists are from the Middle East.

Another USP of medical tourism in Tamil Nadu is its affordability. Compared to many Western countries, the cost of medical treatment in Tamil Nadu is significantly lower, making it an attractive destination for those seeking cost-effective medical care. To support the growth of medical tourism, the Tamil Nadu government has taken steps to improve the infrastructure and facilities for medical tourists. This includes the development of specialized medical tourism hubs. Tamil Nadu also has access to the best medical staff, including technicians and nursing staff.

Medical tourism in Tamil Nadu is a thriving and growing industry that offers patients from around the world access to high-quality medical care, traditional healing practices, and affordable treatment options. With its focus on patient care and commitment to improving the medical tourism experience, Tamil Nadu is poised to become a leading destination for medical tourists in the years to come.

